

WHEN YOU APPLY FOR YOUR FIRST LICENSE

The information and required application forms you need to apply for a learner permit or driver license are available at any motor vehicle office. You can also download them from the DMV website. To apply for a learner permit or driver license you must complete an Application for Driver License (MV-44). You must pass a vision and knowledge test and pay the application and license fees. Most drivers must also complete an approved 5-hour Pre-Licensing Course and pass a road test. For more information about how to apply for and receive a license to drive a motorcycle or a commercial vehicle that requires a CDL, refer to the Motorcycle Operator's Manual (MV-21MC) or the Commercial Driver's Manual (CDL-10).

You must bring your completed application to any motor vehicle office, show the required proof of name and date of birth, provide your Social Security card and pay the correct fee.

Your first New York driver license will be issued for a period not to exceed 5 years, on your month and day of birth. Your fee for a learner permit and license in Class D, DJ, M or MJ will be based on your age and date of birth.

Proof of Identity and Age

For your protection, DMV must be sure who you are. As part of the application, you must provide your Social Security card. You must present documents that prove your name and age. All proofs must be in English or accompanied by a certified English translation. The list of acceptable documents and assigned point values, described below, are on forms License/Permit/ID Instructions (MV-44.1 and MV-44.1RID) and Proofs of Identity (ID-44 and ID-44RID) available from the DMV website (search under Forms) or at any motor vehicle office.

Proof of Name

Documents that prove your name are assigned a point value. You must present proofs that total six points or more. At least one of the proofs must have your signature.

Examples of common proofs and their point values are listed below.

Each document below has a value of 6 points:

- New York Photo Driver License/Permit/Non-Driver ID Card Card (Must be current or not expired for more than 2 years.)

Each document below has a value of 4 points:

- DMV Statement of Identity and/or Residence by Parent/Guardian (MV-45) (If under 21. See special instructions and requirements on the DMV form). Proof of date of birth and an original Social Security card are required for the applicant.
- DMV Statement of Identity and/or Residence (MV-45A) (For applicants represented by Government or Government Approved Facilities.)
- DMV Statement of Identity (MV-45B) (For applicants who can be considered a disenfranchised, homeless youth; not usable for an Enhanced or REAL ID Document.*)
- U.S. Passport or Passport Card (Must be valid.)
- Foreign passport - in English and with a U.S. Visa and valid I-94 or unexpired I-551 stamp or statement on visa. If the document is not in English, a certified translation by the embassy or consulate of the issuing country is required. See the publication Proofs of Identity (ID-44).
- Consular ID Document
- Foreign Driver License with Photo. Must be current or expired no longer than 2 years.
- Photo Driver License/Permit/Non-Driver ID Card issued by another U.S. state, jurisdiction, territory or possession, or, a Canadian province or territory (must be current or expired no longer than 2 years.)